## MAKKAH ZIYARAT: 5

# MAKKAH LIBRARY (BIRTHPLACE)

### Location

On Al-Masjid Al-Haram Road in the Al-Haram district, approximately 250 to 300 meters east of Masjid al-Haram in Makkah, Saudi Arabia.

### Timings

Open to visitors with regulated access; specific visiting hours and entry requirements may apply and should be confirmed with local authorities or the library administration.

### About This Site

The Makkah Al-Mukarramah Library, also known as Maktabah Makkah Al-Mukarramah, stands as one of the most emotionally significant sites in Makkah. This library is built upon the traditionally identified birthplace of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the house where the Messenger of Allah ﷺ first entered this world in the Year of the Elephant, approximately 571 CE. For over fourteen centuries, this location has been recognized by scholars and historians as the sacred spot where the final Prophet of Islam was born, making it a place of profound reverence for Muslims worldwide.

Located in the historic Shi'b Banu Hashim area, near Souq Al-Layl and just a short distance from Masjid al-Haram, this site connects pilgrims directly to the earliest moment of the Prophet's ﷺ earthly life. The library that now occupies this space serves both as a center of Islamic knowledge and as a living memorial to the birth of the man who would change the course of human history. For pilgrims performing Hajj or Umrah, visiting this site offers a unique opportunity to stand where the story of Prophet Muhammad's ﷺ life began, reflecting on the mercy and guidance he brought to all of humanity.

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## Historical Significance

### The Birth of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ

The most significant event associated with this site is the birth of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, which occurred in the house that once stood here. According to Islamic historical sources, the Prophet ﷺ was born on Monday, the 12th of Rabi' al-Awwal, in the Year of the Elephant, corresponding to approximately April 571 CE. This house belonged to his father, Abdullah ibn Abdul Muttalib, and was located in the Shi'b Banu Hashim, the quarter where the Hashim clan resided in Makkah.

- Prophet Muhammad ﷺ was born in this house in the Year of the Elephant (571 CE).
- The house belonged to his father, Abdullah ibn Abdul Muttalib.
- The birth occurred on Monday, 12th of Rabi' al-Awwal according to the majority opinion.

### The House of Abdullah ibn Abdul Muttalib

The original structure on this site was the house of Abdullah ibn Abdul Muttalib, where the Prophet's ﷺ family lived. This house was part of the larger residential area of Shi'b Banu Hashim, where the Hashim clan had their homes. After the Prophet's ﷺ migration to Madinah, the house remained in the possession of his family, specifically his uncle Aqeel ibn Abi Talib, whose descendants later sold it to Muhammad ibn Yusuf al-Thaqafi.

- The house was originally owned by Abdullah ibn Abdul Muttalib, the Prophet's ﷺ father.
- It was located in Shi'b Banu Hashim, the residential quarter of the Hashim clan.
- After the Hijrah, the house remained with Aqeel ibn Abi Talib's descendants.

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## Historical Recognition by Scholars and Authorities

Throughout Islamic history, this site has been widely recognized by scholars, historians, and Islamic authorities as the authentic birthplace of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. Classical historians, including those from the early centuries of Islam, documented this location with consistent chains of narration. In the 20th century, the High Shariah Court of Makkah al-Mukarramah officially affirmed this location through legal deed number 140, dated Jamadi al-Akhirah 1373H (February 1954), confirming its status as the Prophet's ﷺ birthplace.

- Classical Islamic historians consistently identified this location as the Prophet's ﷺ birthplace.
- The High Shariah Court of Makkah officially recognized the site in 1954.
- Scholars across centuries have affirmed the authenticity of this location.

## The Transformation into a Library

In the 20th century, the site underwent a significant transformation when the Makkah Al-Mukarramah Library was constructed over the birthplace. This development preserved the location while repurposing it as a center for Islamic learning and scholarship. The library now serves as both a repository of Islamic knowledge and a memorial to the Prophet's ﷺ birth, ensuring that the site remains accessible to pilgrims and scholars while maintaining its dignity and historical significance.

- The library was built in the 20th century over the birthplace site.
- The library serves as both a scholarly resource and a memorial to the Prophet's ﷺ birth.
- This development ensured the site's continued accessibility to pilgrims and visitors.

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### The Demolition and Reconstruction History

Historical records indicate that the original structure at this site was demolished and reconstructed on multiple occasions. The first major demolition occurred in 1803, and another reconstruction took place in 1924. Despite these changes, the location itself remained consistently identified as the birthplace of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, with scholars and historians continuing to affirm its authenticity throughout these transformations.

- The original structure was demolished and reconstructed in 1803.
- Another reconstruction occurred in 1924 during the early Saudi period.
- Scholars continued to affirm the site's authenticity throughout these transformations.

## The Site Today

### Physical Appearance Today

The Makkah Al-Mukarramah Library is a modest, well-maintained building with simple architecture. It is designed to function as a library while preserving the dignity of the birthplace site. The structure reflects respect for its historical significance without elaborate decoration.

### Historical Remains and Structures

No original structures from the time of Prophet Muhammad's ﷺ birth remain at this site. The current library is a 20th-century construction on the traditionally identified location where the Prophet ﷺ was born.

### Modern Development and Surroundings

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The area around the Makkah Library has developed significantly with Makkah's expansion. It is now located on a main road near Masjid al-Haram, surrounded by modern buildings and infrastructure, yet it remains a distinct landmark.

**Why Pilgrims Still Visit**

Pilgrims visit the Makkah Library (Birthplace) to connect with the story of Prophet Muhammad's ﷺ birth and to reflect on the beginning of his earthly life. This site stands as a unique reminder of the moment when the final Messenger of Allah ﷺ entered this world, bringing mercy and guidance to all of humanity.

For many visitors, standing at the birthplace of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ inspires a deep sense of gratitude, love, and connection to his mission. It is a place to contemplate the profound significance of his life, the sacrifices he made, and the enduring legacy he left for all Muslims. The site serves as a bridge between the past and present, allowing pilgrims to feel connected to the earliest chapter of Islamic history.

**Frequently Asked Questions**

**What is the significance of the Makkah Library (Birthplace)?**

The Makkah Library is built upon the traditionally identified birthplace of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, where he was born in the Year of the Elephant (571 CE), making it a site of profound historical and spiritual importance.

**Where is the Makkah Library (Birthplace) located in Makkah?**

It is on Al-Masjid Al-Haram Road in the Al-Haram district, approximately 250 to 300 meters east of Masjid al-Haram in Makkah, Saudi Arabia.

**Can visitors access the Makkah Library (Birthplace) today?**

Access is regulated by Saudi authorities; visitors may be permitted entry during specific

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hours, and entry requirements should be confirmed with local authorities or the library administration before visiting.

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